JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with 14 years of experience building and scaling distributed systems in the financial services and SaaS sectors. I've led technical strategy across multiple organisations, mentored senior engineering teams, and driven architectural decisions that improved system reliability and performance. I'm most interested in solving complex infrastructure challenges and helping teams grow their technical capabilities.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, Kotlin, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, Google Cloud

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra

Messaging: Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Containerization: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm

DevOps Tools: Terraform, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, CloudFormation

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, DataDog

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, Load Balancing, VPN, TLS/SSL

Architecture Patterns: Microservices, Event-Driven, CQRS, Domain-Driven Design

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

Nexus Financial Systems

nexusfinance.io

Glasgow, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Architected and implemented a real-time transaction processing system handling 50,000+ transactions per second across multiple regions using Kafka and Kubernetes, reducing latency by 40 percent from previous implementation.

Led a team of 8 senior engineers through a complete microservices migration from a monolithic Java application, establishing patterns and standards that reduced deployment time from 4 hours to 15 minutes.

Designed and deployed a multi-region disaster recovery strategy using AWS and Terraform, achieving 99.99 percent uptime across all production systems with automated failover capabilities.

Mentored 5 engineers in their progression to senior roles through structured technical reviews, architecture discussions, and hands-on pairing sessions focused on system design and problem-solving.

Senior Platform Engineer

CloudScale Innovations

cloudscale.co

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

August 2017 - February 2021

Built a containerized platform using Kubernetes that standardized deployment practices across 12 development teams, reducing infrastructure provisioning time by 70 percent and improving security posture.

Established observability practices by implementing Prometheus and Grafana across 200+ microservices, enabling the team to reduce mean time to resolution from 45 minutes to 8 minutes for incidents.

Authored infrastructure-as-code patterns in Terraform that reduced manual configuration and infrastructure deployment errors by 85 percent, handling AWS resources across development, staging, and production environments.

Optimized database performance for high-traffic PostgreSQL clusters by implementing read replicas, connection pooling, and query optimization, improving application response times by 55 percent during peak load.

Senior Engineer

DataStream Solutions

datastream.net

Glasgow, United Kingdom

July 2010 - July 2017

Developed distributed data pipeline services in Java and Python that processed 2 terabytes of data daily, architecting solutions using Kafka and Spark for real-time analytics and reporting.

Led the design and implementation of a multi-tenant SaaS platform that served 30+ enterprise clients, implementing role-based access control, data isolation, and API rate limiting using PostgreSQL and Redis.

Conducted system design reviews and established coding standards for a team of 6 engineers, reducing production defects by 45 percent and improving code review cycle time through clear architectural guidelines.

Managed infrastructure migration from on-premises data centers to AWS, planning and executing cutover of 50+ applications with zero downtime, resulting in 35 percent reduction in operational costs.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

2008 - 2010

BSc Computer Science

University of Glasgow

Glasgow, United Kingdom

2004 - 2008

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional

Certified Kubernetes Administrator